

IESE

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT IESE

IESE was founded in 1958 and is part of the University of Navarra. The philosophy of the school is based on a people-centered, integrative, and socially responsible approach to business, building on their values of professional excellence, integrity, and spirit of service. The main campus of IESE is in Barcelona, Spain, with additional campuses in New York, Sao Paulo, Shanghai, and Nairobi.

Central to the learning experience on the IESE MBA is the Case Method. In highly diverse and international teams, IESE MBAs work through more than 600 cases during the programme. During the elective portfolio, students can choose from four concentrations: International Business, Finance, Data Analytics & Digital Business, and Entrepreneurship & Innovation.

Beyond the entrepreneurship curriculum, students have the opportunity to do a summer entrepreneurship experience, working in project teams on either their own idea or someone else's. Finaves offers IESE alumni seed funding of between €50k-€300k to get off the ground in exchange for a minority stake. And the IESE Business Angel's Network, which has facilitated investments of over €50m to more than 290 business founded by IESE alumni, serves as a platform to connect entrepreneurs seeking financing to grow and investors looking for opportunities to invest. Budding entrepreneurs would do well to investigate IESE's impressive entrepreneurial ecosystem.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Global nature and scope, general management, leadership development, entrepreneurial mindset, two different lengths, concentration option, exchange program.

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	6	5	7	4	5	3	4	6
Financial Times	4	6	3	8	7	5	3	3
Forbes	-	12	-	2	-	2	-	3
The Economist	1	1	2	3	1	2	1	2
US News	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

CLASS OF 2020 ADMISSIONS

MBA Class Size	356
Total Tuition	€89,950
Avg Age	29 to 31
Avg GMAT	681
% International	85%
% Women	26%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2020)

Consulting	33%
Technology	26%
Industry	21%
Financial Services	20%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

AT Kearny, Bain & Company, McKinsey & Company, Monitor Deloitte, The Boston Consulting Group, Amazon, Google, Microsoft, Samsung, Wayfair, AB InBev, Eli Lilly

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: €86,282

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 87%

**Rankings are relative to other non-U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.*



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR IESE APPLICATION

BY LISA BEVILL

Lisa Bevill is former Admissions Director at IE Business School, and has enjoyed a long and successful global admissions career. She brings extensive experience reviewing admission files at a number of top MBA programs, from IE and IESE to LBS, Oxford, Cambridge, and IMD.



**Showcase your leadership journey
through stories, not just titles.**

1

DEMONSTRATE YOUR COMMITMENT TO EXCELLENCE

IESE is an institution with excellence at its core. The educational environment, career development, and experience are designed to impact from the strategy down to the detail. Considering, applicants should align with excellence and demonstrate how their choices allow them to excel. How is excellence demonstrated in your work? How can you take care in your application to align with this value?

SHARE YOUR LEADERSHIP STORY

2

Career progression is important and demonstrating your ability to lead yourself and others is critical. What is your leadership journey? Consider where you are on your journey, leveraging various experiences and how IESE will allow you to further hone your leadership skills. It is important to be authentic in conveying your leadership abilities. Take time to reflect on the roles where you have been able to influence and impact decisions and teams. Showcase your leadership journey through stories, not just titles.

3

PROVIDE INSIGHT INTO YOUR GLOBAL PERSPECTIVE

IESE prides itself on its global impact and diversity within the classroom. Your ability to be at ease on a global playing field is key. While the MBA will further provide opportunities to gain greater international perspective, coming with an open mindset and specific examples of being globally minded is important. Consider the companies you have worked for, the impact of the projects you have contributed to, and your own global network to demonstrate how you embrace a global mindset and approach to business.

YOUR IMPACT ON THE WORLD

4

What are your overarching values and how they have shaped your life decisions? IESE wants holistic individuals who are able to create sustainable businesses and build communities. Your personal interests and passion for development will allow you to stand out in the applicant pool. Share who you are and why you choose the work you do. Also consider how you will positively impact the IESE Community during and beyond your MBA.

5

SHOW YOUR COMMITMENT

IESE has five campuses around the world and hosts Assessment Days to get to know candidates. This is a unique element to the IESE application process, showing their commitment to holistic evaluation. Show your commitment to getting to know the school and other candidates by getting involved in events and attending the Assessment Days. These are opportunities for you to shine, be who you are and demonstrate your alignment with the school values. Go prepared to live an MBA experience and appreciate that this is a chance to show your best self in person (or virtually!), more so than on paper!

ESSAY ANALYSIS



ESSAY 1. If you had to come up with a motto for your life, what would it be and why? Please give an example of how you have demonstrated it (word limit 300 max)

This is an invitation to showcase your authenticity and what you believe in. This essay challenges you to consider what you value and how that is represented in a motto (slogan/tagline/claim) for your life, supported by an emblematic example to back it up.

Take the opportunity to reflect on your life and values and what is really important for you. Allow yourself to get creative here! Tapping into your values allows you to show overarching themes that have guided your major decisions, which also align with your motivations for applying to the IESE MBA. The examples are a way to weave your story together, showcasing how the themes play out in your life, creating the common thread. (Note the wording is “life” not work, so even if you consider work your life, stretch yourself to play with possibilities.)

Be authentic and tap into what guides your decision and how IESE fits with your life motto. Remember to keep your audience in mind: the MBA Admissions Committee. Imagine what you want IESE to take away from the essay before you try to capture that experience in a personal motto.

ESSAY 2. Describe your short and medium term post-MBA goals? How will the IESE MBA help you achieve them? (word limit 300 max)

Career progression and leadership impact are considered critical in the IESE application. This question, while open, aims at specific career goals, which should be aspirational, aligned, and realistic. This question should also fit with the previous and show how your future vision fits with your life motto, as well as how the MBA will help you achieve them.

This question is aimed more at the plan to impact following the MBA. When considering time frames, your medium-term post MBA goal is generally where you plan to be 6-8 years out, while your short-term MBA goals are the steppingstones paving the way to get there. Short-term goals involve your near-immediate plans – either for an internship and/or two to three years post b-school – and should be specific. This is also the time to highlight why the IESE MBA is critical to your career growth. During this period, you should be acquiring specific expertise or skills that is essential for you to reach your long-term vision.

Your long-term vision defines your end goal, the peak of your career, and unlike short term goals, it's unnecessary to delve into exacting detail. Instead, your focus should be on the impact you want to have throughout your professional career. The admissions committee wants to know your values and motivations and the impact you want to have in your region, industry, or in the world.

View this terrific blog by Heidi Hills for more advice and examples of crafting your short and long term post-MBA goals.

ESSAY 3. What would you like to highlight about yourself or your journey which may have not been captured in your application?
(word limit 300 max)

IESE looks holistically at candidates, aiming to attract global citizens with social impact. This is your opportunity to show how you align with those values. The third question is optional; however, it is always recommended to take advantage of the space to share your story. This question could be used to provide insight into a less professional element that might have shaped who you are, such as the perseverance learned in playing the piano, the cultural awareness and perspective gained from traveling, or the joy and gratitude of service. This question should align with the core themes of the application, the motto for your life, and provide additional insight into your story.

This open-style question is an opportunity to showcase your interests and passion and is not to be wasted! Reflect on a part of your story that you have not yet conveyed and that provides insight into who you are and what you value.

As always, the essays and application should be coherent and professional, and it is recommended all essays and applications be extremely polished. Given the personality of the school, the attention to detail, appreciation of the network and career growth, and your professionalism could add subtle value.

DEADLINES & DATES

	Application Deadline	Interview Decision Deadline	Final Decision Deadline
Early Decision Round	1 Sept 2020	16 Sept 2020	23 Oct 2020
R1	6 Oct 2020	20 Oct. 2020	12 Dec 2020
R2	5 Jan 2021	22 Jan 2021	23 March 2021
R3	10 March 2021	25 March 2021	24 May 2021
R4	4 May 2021	18 May 2021	18 June 2021



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, MIT Sloan, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson, and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

